

Interviewee: Male, 21, UCD student (Engineering)

Section	Question	Response
The Commute / Routine		
	Can you walk me through your typical day in Dublin?	Yeah so... I wake up around 8, 8:30 if I'm being honest. I'm over in Ranelagh sharing a house with three others. I've got a 9 AM lecture on Mondays so that's the worst day. Usually I just ... Luas from Beechwood, takes me to Broombridge and then I get the bus the rest of the way. It's grand most days but if the Luas is packed it's just... ugh.
	How do you currently get from point A to point B?	Mainly Luas and bus combo. Sometimes I walk if it's not raining, like it's only 40 minutes from Ranelagh. But honestly when it's raining I'm not doing that. I used to have a bike back home in Galway but I didn't bring it up.
Current Bike Usage		
	Do you currently cycle in the city?	No, not really. I mean I've tried it once or twice, borrowed a mate's bike. It was... fine? But like I don't have one here.
	What holds you back from cycling?	Couple things. Cost of buying a bike, I'm on a student budget. And honestly the traffic scares me a bit, like the quays and stuff. I nearly got clipped by a bus once on my mate's bike and that put me off for a while.
Competitor Analysis		
	Have you used DublinBikes, Bleeper, or Moby before?	DublinBikes yeah, a few times. Bleeper I think I tried once. Moby ... I've seen them around but never used one.

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	What's the one thing that frustrates you most about them?	DublinBikes ... the docking stations. Like there was one time I cycled all the way to campus and every dock near the Belfield entrance was full. I had to go way around and I was late. That was so annoying. And like, you can't just leave it anywhere, you know?
Weather Factor		
	Dublin rain is inevitable. How does the weather currently dictate your transport choices?	Massive factor honestly. If I check my phone in the morning and it says rain I'm not even considering the bike. I'm just going Luas. Even light rain ... I don't have great gear. I've got a rain jacket but cycling in jeans when it's wet is just miserable.
Safety Perception		
	On a scale of 1 to 10, how safe do you feel cycling in Dublin city centre?	Probably like... a 5? Maybe a 4 on a bad day. It depends so much on the road. Some of the cycle lanes are actually decent now but then you hit a stretch with no lane and you're just hoping for the best.
	What specific areas or situations make you nervous?	The quays definitely. And like, turning right at big junctions ... I never know if I should just do it or wait. And buses pulling out, that's nerve-wracking. Also cycling at night, visibility is just worse and some drivers... yeah.
Cost vs. Convenience		
	Cheaper ride with a 5-min walk to a dock, or slightly more expensive dockless bike you can park anywhere?	Dockless, every time. The docking station thing is so stressful. If I know I can just leave the bike outside the Arts building and lock it there, that's worth paying a bit more. The walk kills the time saving.

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The Social Aspect		
	Do you ever travel in groups? How easy is it to organize a group ride?	Sometimes yeah, like after a night out or going to a match. Group cycling is kind of a nightmare with DublinBikes because you're all scrambling to find enough bikes at the same station. One time three of us were trying and there were only two bikes. So one person had to walk and catch up. Not ideal.
Night / Safety		
	It's 11 PM and you've been at the library or the pub. What's your go-to way home? Would you consider a bike share?	Honestly? Probably walk if it's dry and I'm sober enough, or Uber if I'm with people and we can split it. Bike at 11 PM... I don't know. The lighting on some routes is just bad. And like, I'm not exactly at my most alert. I'd consider it if the route felt safe and well-lit but I probably wouldn't chance the quays at that hour.
Campus Commute		
	How do you handle the last mile onto campus? Do current bike stations get you close enough?	Not really. The nearest DublinBikes station is like a 10-minute walk from the main lecture buildings still. So you end up walking anyway. If there was a station right at the front gate it'd be different but right now it doesn't really solve the last mile for me.

Interviewee: Female, 34, Marketing Manager, works in Grand Canal Dock

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The Commute / Routine		
	Can you walk me through your typical day in Dublin?	So I'm in Clontarf, up around 7. I've got to be at the office for 9 but I usually try to get in by 8:45 to get ahead of things. I take the DART most days it's fairly reliable from Clontarf to Grand Canal Dock, direct, which is great. Takes about 20 minutes if there are no delays.
	How do you currently get from point A to point B?	DART is my main thing. Sometimes I drive if I've got evening plans or a client meeting somewhere I can't get to easily. I've cycled to work maybe... 8 or 10 times in the last year? Not consistently. I always mean to do it more.
Current Bike Usage		
	Do you currently cycle in the city?	Occasionally, yeah. I have my own bike at home, a hybrid. But it's the logistics ... I need to shower at work and our building only has one shower for the whole floor so the timing is stressful. And then locking the bike outside, I've had a friend's bike nicked near work so I'm paranoid about that.
	If no, what holds you back?	It's a combination of things. The shower situation. The fact that I usually wear ... I mean I can't turn up in lycra to a client meeting. And I genuinely worry about the bike getting stolen. If there was secure parking at the office I'd probably cycle more.
Competitor Analysis		

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Section	Question	Response
	Have you used DublinBikes, Bleeper, or Moby before?	DublinBikes yes, quite a bit actually. I got the annual membership a couple of years ago. Bleeper I've used a handful of times when there wasn't a DublinBikes nearby. Moby... I've seen them but they look a bit beaten up honestly, I haven't tried one.
	What's the one thing that frustrates you most about them?	The availability at peak times is just awful. I've walked to a station at 8:50 in the morning and it's empty. Every single bike gone. And then I'm scrambling do I walk, do I get a taxi? I've missed the start of meetings because of it. And sometimes the docks near the office are completely full when I'm trying to return one, so you're cycling around the block looking for a free dock. It adds this... anxiety to the whole experience.
Weather Factor		
	Dublin rain is inevitable. How does the weather currently dictate your transport choices?	Rain is a hard no for me with cycling. I've done it once, arrived completely drenched, had to buy a new top in Penneys on my lunch. Never again. So yeah, any rain forecast and I'm on the DART. Which means realistically I probably only cycle maybe 30 days a year given Irish weather.
Safety Perception		

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	On a scale of 1 to 10, how safe do you feel cycling in Dublin city centre?	I'd say 6. I'm fairly confident on the bike generally but there are stretches I really don't like. The Grand Canal Dock area is actually okay, there's decent infrastructure. But if I need to go into town ... O'Connell Street area, the quays ... it drops to like a 4. It's the HGVs mostly. And the left-turn lanes where you're kind of invisible to turning trucks.
	What specific areas or situations make you nervous?	North Quays, definitely. And anywhere there's construction because the cycle lane just... disappears. You're suddenly in with the traffic with no warning. Also the point where the bike lane ends and you have to merge ... that transition is really poorly signposted.
Reliability & Availability		
	Walk me through your morning rush. What happens if you get to a bike station and it's empty?	I've started checking the app before I leave. But even then it updates slowly and by the time I get there it might be gone. If it's empty I usually just walk to the DART. Which means I'm probably late. It's happened enough times that now I give myself a buffer but that feels like ... I shouldn't have to do that, you know? It's supposed to make my commute easier not add buffer time.
	How does that impact your day?	It just starts the day on the back foot. I'm a bit frantic, I'm sending apology messages on my phone as I'm walking. And then I've skipped breakfast because I was counting on being faster. It sounds small but it's genuinely stressful when it keeps happening.

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The Sweat Factor		
	Does the effort of cycling affect your decision to ride to work?	Absolutely. I mean Clontarf to Grand Canal is not a short cycle. And there are bits that are kind of uphill-ish. I've arrived... not looking my best, let's say. The shower situation makes it worse because if I have to wait for the shower I'm adding 20 minutes and then I'm late. It's a whole calculation.
	Would an e-bike option change how often you cycle in professional attire?	Yes, genuinely. If I could get an e-bike and arrive not sweating through my blouse ... yes. I'd probably cycle three or four times a week. The e-assist just takes the edge off, especially into a headwind. And Dublin is very windy.
Multi-modal Transport		
	Do you combine cycling with the Luas or DART?	I've done it ... cycle to the DART station, lock up, get the train. But it's annoying because I have to own a bike, lock it outside, and then I'm worrying about it all day. There's no covered parking at Clontarf Road station. If I could fold a bike and bring it on the DART that'd be ideal but the bikes I've used for share schemes aren't foldable obviously.
	What's the most painful part of switching between a train and a bike?	The dock situation at the train station end. There's never a DublinBikes station right at the DART stop. You get off and then you have to walk 5-7 minutes to the nearest station. That gap is so frustrating. You've done the hard bit and then the last connection fails you.
Subscription Models		

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	Would you prefer pay-as-you-go, or a monthly flat fee through a Cycle to Work scheme?	Cycle to Work would be ideal if the company offers it. Mine sort of does but it's very focused on buying your own bike. If there was a subscription model that sat under that scheme I'd be in straight away. Pay-as-you-go feels fine for occasional use but if I'm commuting regularly I want certainty. A monthly cap or flat fee so I know what I'm spending.

Interviewee: Female, 28, arrived from Tokyo a week ago, solo traveller (first time in Ireland)

Section	Question	Response
The Commute / Routine		
	Can you walk me through your typical day in Dublin?	Sure, um. I'm staying in a hostel near Parnell Square. Each day I look at my list of things to see and I try to walk mostly. Yesterday I walked to Trinity, then to the Docklands. Maybe 20,000 steps? My feet are very tired. I want to see more today but I think I need a different way to travel.
	How do you currently get from point A to point B?	Walking, mainly. I tried the bus once but I did not understand the route and I ended up in the wrong place. Google Maps helped but the stops are confusing ... the names are long and I couldn't read the sign fast enough before the bus moved. I have not tried the Luas yet. Today maybe.
Current Bike Usage		
	Do you currently cycle? Back home or here?	In Tokyo I cycle every day! I have a mamachari ... like a city bike ... for going to the station. But in Tokyo cycling is very... organised? There are paths everywhere and the rules are clear. Here I am not sure about the rules. And the cars drive on the opposite side. So I have not tried cycling here yet.
	What holds you back from cycling here?	The left side of the road. In Japan it is also left so normally that is okay, but when I am nervous and thinking about navigation at the same time ... I am worried I will make a mistake at a junction. Also I don't know which roads are safe. And I don't know how to rent one yet. I saw some bikes yesterday near the river but I didn't know how to start.

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Competitor Analysis		
	Have you seen or heard of DublinBikes, Bleeper, or Moby?	I saw the blue ones near the river ... is that DublinBikes? I didn't know the name. The others I have not heard of. I looked at the bike station and it had a screen but I didn't understand what it needed from me ... card, app, something? I wasn't sure so I just walked on.
	What is your impression of them from the outside?	The blue bikes look okay, they look solid. But the station looked complicated. Like there were instructions but they were quite small and I couldn't tell what step one was. In Tokyo the bike share ... I just tap my IC card and go. Very fast. Here it seemed like more steps were needed and I wasn't sure I had the right thing.
Weather Factor		
	Dublin rain is inevitable. How does the weather currently dictate your transport choices?	Oh, the rain! Yesterday it rained for maybe one hour in the afternoon ... I was at St Stephen's Green and I had no umbrella. I was completely wet. If I am on a bike and it rains... I think I stop? But I don't know where to leave the bike. In Japan I just park anywhere. Here I don't know the rules for that. I think rain would make me very anxious on a bike.
Safety Perception		

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	On a scale of 1 to 10, how safe do you feel cycling in Dublin city centre?	Honestly, maybe a 3? I have not tried so maybe it is better than I think. But from watching the traffic ... it seems very fast and the roads are not wide. And the buses are very big. I see cyclists and they look confident but I don't feel that confident here. In Tokyo, even with traffic, I know the system. Here I don't know what is expected of me.
	What specific areas or situations make you nervous?	The big intersections near the river. And when there is no cycle lane and the cars are very close. I also don't know what the hand signals are here ... do cyclists use them? And traffic lights ... if the light is green for me and also for a turning car, who has priority? I don't know and that worries me.
Onboarding Friction		
	You just landed in Dublin. You see a bike. Walk me through what you expect the rental process to look like. At what point would you give up and just call an Uber?	I expect... maybe I tap my card or use my phone. Like Apple Pay? And then I get a code or the bike unlocks. Simple. If it needs me to download an app first ... I might do it if the app is small and easy. But if I need to create an account, put in my address, verify my email... I think at that point I give up. Maybe if it takes more than two minutes total I just call a taxi. My data here is expensive so I also don't want to use too much trying to figure it out.
Navigation & Wayfinding		

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	Do you know your way around Dublin? How would you handle navigation while on a bike?	Not very well, no. Dublin is smaller than Tokyo so I am getting better but ... no. I would use Google Maps. But on a bike, looking at my phone... that is dangerous. I would need to stop to check. A phone mount would be very useful. Or if the bike told me where to go with arrows on a screen ... like some bikes in Asia have. That would make me much more confident.
	Would a phone mount or built-in navigation influence your choice?	Yes, definitely. If I see a bike with a phone mount already attached I would feel more comfortable. It shows the service is designed for people who don't know the city. It is a small thing but it makes a big difference for me.
Traffic Anxiety		
	Dublin traffic drives on the left. Does this make you hesitate?	Yes and no. Japan is also left so the basic direction is okay. But the junctions are different. In Japan I know how to read the junction. Here the signs are different, the road markings are different, and sometimes there are no markings at all. I think if someone showed me one route ... just one safe route ... I would be okay. But without that guidance I am nervous to start.

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	What features would make you feel safer?	A quiet route option, not the fastest. I would rather take 5 more minutes if I'm away from the big lorries. And maybe some kind of warning in the app when I am approaching a difficult junction. In Tokyo some apps do this. Also ... if I can see where other cyclists are going, like a heat map of popular routes, that would help me trust the path.
Payment Methods		
	Do you have data roaming? Would a heavy app prevent you from renting?	I have a small roaming package ... it was expensive. So yes, downloading a large app with lots of photos and setup screens, I would avoid that. Especially in the first few days when I am trying to save data. If the app is light ... or if there is a web option I can use in a browser without downloading ... that is much better. And Apple Pay or Google Pay without needing to set up an account would be ideal. I was not expecting to need to plan this before I arrived.